How TCP and UDP work

Transmission Control Protocol (TCP) forms the backbone of the internet. Every time you send an email your valuable information, in the form of data packets follow rules laid out in TCP. We look at how your information travels from the source (your computer) to your intended destination (the recipient of your message)...

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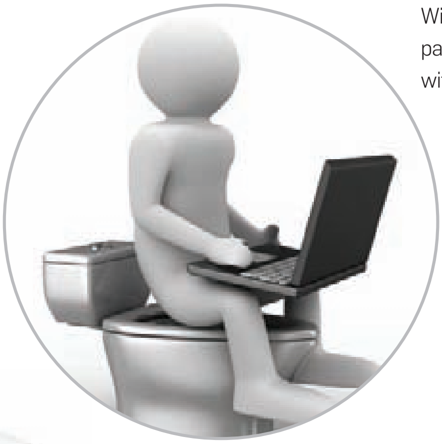
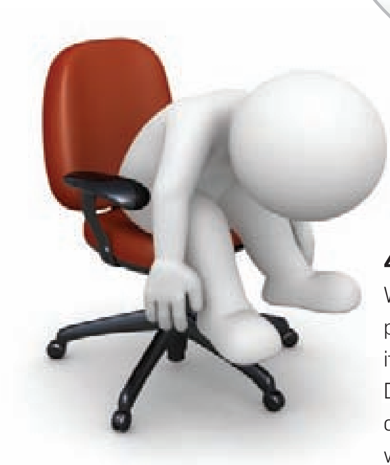
Before www comes *http*
We've overlooked what precedes URLs on the world wide web. HTTP, governs how we view web pages. All these rules form what we know as the Internet Protocol (IP).



1. Hi, welcome!
With IP, and TCP in particular, all communication at the packet level occurs as handshakes (to and fro communication) with signals and acknowledgements continuously offered

2. Start right away
Just as you enrol with a tutor at home to get personal attention, TCP ensures minimal packet (information) loss by verifying information at every stage



4. Wake up!
With a detailed mechanism in place to minimise data corruption, it's smooth sailing all through. Don't doze though. Unlike in a classroom, a tuition teacher will catch you right away

3. First level check passed...
After identifying the correct destination server via domain name servers, there are a series of sync, clock and error correction mechanisms that work towards ensuring zero information loss. This is like your tution teacher giving you mock exams to make sure you know your stuff.

5. The next step!
There are parity checks in place so that any data losses are compensated by re-sending the packets

6. As per plan...
Think of the previous step as a tutor making you cram, because their reputation depends on your results